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CINNOVATE SOLUTIONS (OPC) PRIVATE LIMITED

CIN : U62099RJ2025OPC100267

Department Wise Audit Report

Logistics & Dispatch

Freight, Export & Order Processing — Nihal M Paliwal

An independent operational review of the Logistics & Dispatch department, evaluating order intake discipline, carrier coordination, custom packaging workflows, and export compliance processes, prepared as part of the EF Polymer Private Limited organization-wide operational audit by Creative Upaay (brand owned by Cinnovate Solutions (OPC) Private Limited).

CLIENT	EF Polymer Private Limited
PREPARED BY	Creative Upaay
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DEPARTMENT SCOPE	Logistics, Supply Chain & Export Ops



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SECTION 01 — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Department Overview

Scope, current state, and headline findings

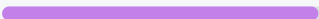
The Logistics department, led by Nihal M Paliwal, manages the full dispatch lifecycle for EF Polymer Private Limited — covering domestic B2B and RCM orders daily, international export shipments of 10–15 orders per month, and the custom packaging pipeline for white-label B2B clients.

The audit identified three interconnected friction points pulling down operational efficiency. First, 70–80% of domestic sales orders arrive via unstructured WhatsApp messages with missing mandatory fields, forcing the Logistics Head into manual back-and-forth clarification before billing can begin. Second, Zoho Books (invoicing) and the Google Sheets tracking system are entirely siloed — every shipment requires double data entry across both systems. Third, the custom packaging lead time of 15–20 days with no upstream sales forecast creates recurring risk of missing export vessel windows.

10–15 EXPORT ORDERS / MONTH	70–80% LAST-MINUTE ORDERS (SALES)	15–20 Days CUSTOM PACKAGING LEAD TIME	1.6 / 5.0 OVERALL MATURITY SCORE
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About the Maturity Score

A 1–5 scale measuring how systematised, documented, and independently operable the department is. Scored across five dimensions: Process, Technology, Data Quality, Documentation & Knowledge Management.

1 — Ad hoc  5 — Optimised

■ **1.6** Current state ■ **3.0** Post-roadmap target ○ **5.0** Best-in-class benchmark



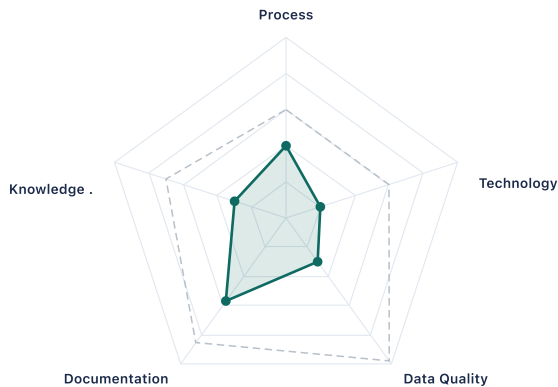
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SECTION 02 — BENCHMARKING

Department Maturity Assessment



Solid line: current state. Dashed line: target state (post-roadmap).

Logistics scores 1.6 overall — Operational competence in carrier management and physical dispatch is real, but the department is artificially hobbled by poor upstream data quality (WhatsApp ordering) and completely siloed technology systems (Zoho Books disconnected from Sheets).

Enforcing structured order intake via the Logistics Dashboard and connecting Zoho Books to the tracking layer will structurally lift the Data Quality and Technology dimensions, which together represent the largest drag on current scores.

DIMENSION	CURRENT	TARGET	GAP
Process Standardization	2.0	3.0	1.0
Technology Utilization	1.0	3.0	2.0
Data Quality & Accessibility	1.5	3.5	2.0
Documentation	2.0	3.0	1.0
Knowledge Management	1.5	2.5	1.0
Overall	1.6	3.0	1.4



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SECTION 03 — ORGANIZATION

Team Structure & Tools

Personnel footprint and the core technology stack in use

Team Structure

Reporting hierarchy within Logistics, led by Nihal Paliwal (Logistics Manager) under Rishabh Doshi (Production Manager) and Narayan Lal Gurjar (Founder & CEO).



Tools in Use



WhatsApp

Primary channel (70–80% of daily comms) — order intake, carrier coordination, internal status updates



Google Sheets

Dispatch tracking, vendor rate comparisons, transit timelines, partner contact lists — fully manual, no automation



Zoho Books

Invoice and delivery challan generation — operated by Accounts team, entirely siloed from Logistics Sheets



Google Drive

Dedicated export document folders per client/partner — PDFs uploaded manually per shipment



Email

External vendor coordination (transporters, forwarders).



Slack

Internal dispatch updates and cross-team coordination.



Physical Records

Printed gate passes, challans, and transport receipts for government audit compliance — no digital backup



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SECTION 03 — PROCESS DETAIL

Current Workflows

Where each finding sits inside the operational process

Domestic Dispatch Workflow



What is good: Direct coordination allows for prompt physical loading once data is clean.

What needs to be fixed: Replace unstructured WhatsApp orders with a mandatory structured intake form via the Logistics Dashboard. Connect tracking directly to Zoho Books.

Bottlenecks: Logistics Manager acts as a manual data validator for missing info (F-01). Siloed Zoho Books delays billing (F-02).

Dependencies: Sales Team (accurate order intake data), Accounts Team (timely manual billing trigger).

International Shipping & Export Workflow — F-03



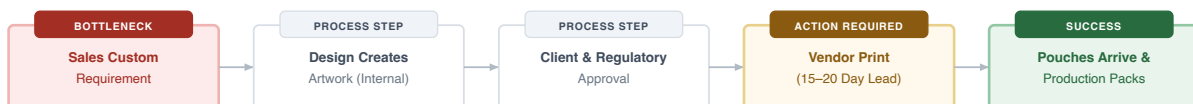
What is good: Established checklist for required declarations and customs loading.

What needs to be fixed: Where carrier APIs are available, integrate them for automated vessel schedule alerts. Where APIs are unavailable, use a dashboard-connected tracking form to manage IDs/links and provide visibility across departments.

Bottlenecks: A minimum 1-week prep window is vulnerable to manual miscommunications when schedules shift without alerts.

Dependencies: Destination Agent (Handoff), Carrier (Schedule updates).

Custom Packaging & Design Workflow — F-04



What is good: Dedicated design team turns around artwork efficiently.

What needs to be fixed: Lack of upstream Sales pipeline visibility means pouches are ordered reactively. All packaging records, forecasts, and tracking must be consolidated into the Logistics Dashboard.

Bottlenecks: Vendor MOQ limitations and 15–20 day print lead time with no advance forecasting.



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APPENDIX

Cross-Department Dependencies

Findings and recommendations that require action outside the Logistics department to resolve

Sales & Business Development

Critical Upstream Dependency

Operations Dependency

70–80% of all domestic orders originate from Sales reps posting on WhatsApp, frequently missing mandatory fields (pin codes, GST number, SKU, packaging type). Sales must adopt the structured intake form before any dispatch can begin.

 Key Person: Sales Head / BD Lead

Critical Bottleneck

Every incomplete order forces Nihal to spend 10–25 minutes per order chasing basic data. Sales also provides no pipeline forecast for custom packaging, causing reactive 15–20 day delays that risk missing export vessel windows.

Data Transfer & Updates Needed

Sales must use the Logistics Dashboard intake form exclusively. A rolling 30-day custom packaging forecast must be shared and tracked in the dashboard. All reorder data from repeat clients must be surfaced from the shared data layer so Sales doesn't need to re-confirm every time.

Finance & Accounts

Operational Handoff

Operations Dependency

Accounts operates Zoho Books independently. Every shipment requires Logistics to manually request invoice generation and then re-enter the same data into their tracking Sheets — creating a dual-entry loop with zero automation.

 Key Person: Finance / Accounts Manager

Critical Bottleneck

Manual double-entry between Zoho Books and Google Sheets for every single shipment introduces typing errors in billing versus tracking records, and wastes ~30% of the department's daily time on documentation.

Data Transfer & Updates Needed

Accounts must grant API access to Zoho Books for the Logistics Dashboard integration. The auto-generation and upload of e-gate passes, delivery challans, and other shipping documents to Google Sheets and Google Drive must be fully automated — eliminating the current manual Zoho → PDF → Drive → email loop.

Production & CXO Visibility

Visibility & Scheduling

Operations Dependency

Production batch readiness (e.g., ~10 days per 2MT) directly gates export vessel booking. CXOs require real-time visibility into shipment statuses without having to ask Nihal directly.

 Key Persons: CXOs (Puran Sir, Narayan Sir)

Critical Bottleneck

No single dashboard exists for CXOs to check any shipment status. All visibility is routed through Nihal, consuming a disproportionate share of the Logistics Head's time on status updates rather than operations.

Data Transfer & Updates Needed

The Logistics Dashboard must provide CXOs with role-based read access to shipment statuses. Production batch readiness milestones must be visible within the same dashboard to allow Logistics to plan vessel



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SECTION 04 — OPERATIONAL PAIN POINTS

Pain Points Register

Ranked by operational impact. Each pain point is cross-referenced to its recommendation in Section 06.

Priority Focus Areas:

- ① **Order Intake Discipline** — 70–80% of domestic orders arrive via unstructured WhatsApp messages missing critical fields. This single failure cascades into billing delays, documentation errors, and wasted Logistics Head time every single day.
- ② **Data Fragmentation & Silo** — No single dashboard exists for all domestic and international shipments. Zoho Books, Google Sheets, and Google Drive operate as completely separate silos with no automation connecting them.

	PAIN POINT	IMPACT	EVIDENCE FROM AUDIT
F-01	Incomplete WhatsApp Order Intake. Orders are entered via WhatsApp text with missing mandatory fields (pin codes, GST number, SKU weight, packaging type).	CRITICAL	Forces Logistics Head to spend 10–25 minutes per order manually chasing Sales for missing compliance data before billing can begin.
F-02	Disconnected Invoicing & Shipping Data. Zoho Books, Google Sheets, and Google Drive operate as three entirely separate silos with zero automation.	CRITICAL	Requires manual double data entry for every shipment; risks typing errors in billing vs. tracking; consumes ~30% of the team's daily time.
F-03	No Real-Time Carrier / Vessel Visibility. Vessel prepone/postpone decisions arrive unpredictably with very little lead time, and there is no automated alert system.	HIGH	If cargo is not at port before cutoff (even by 1–2 days), the vessel is missed entirely. Team builds a 2–4 day manual buffer to compensate.
F-04	Unforecasted Custom Packaging Delays. White-label packaging requires 15–20 days with external vendor MOQ constraints, and Sales provides no advance forecast.	CRITICAL	Without a Sales pipeline forecast, packaging orders are placed reactively, delaying export dispatches by weeks and causing vessel misses.
F-05	No Centralized Shipment Tracking Dashboard. All shipment data, tracking IDs, and document statuses are scattered across Sheets and WhatsApp groups with no unified view.	HIGH	CXOs (Puran Sir, Narayan Sir) cannot check any shipment status without calling Nihal directly. No searchable shipment record exists.



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SECTION 05 — TIME & EFFORT**Time & Effort Allocation**

Stated directly by Nihal M Paliwal (Logistics Head) during the audit interview. Based on a standard working day averaged across domestic and export order mix.

ACTIVITY	SHARE OF DAY	EST. TIME / DAY
Carrier Coordination & Scheduling	~35%	~2h 48m
Documentation & Billing (Invoice / E-Way Bill / BL)	~30%	~2h 24m
Exception Chasing, Follow-ups & Data Validation	~20%	~1h 36m
Physical Loading & Stuffing Supervision	~15%	~1h 12m

Manager Comms Overhead (stated directly)

SCENARIO	LOGISTICS HEAD TIME SPENT	NOTES
Small domestic order (straightforward)	~10% of day	Complete info arrives; Logistics confirms and delegates to team
Large / complex domestic order	~30% of day	Multiple back-and-forths with Sales, Production, Accounts
International dispatch day	100% of full day	Stuffing supervision, customs, freight forwarder emails, follow-ups



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SECTION 06 — CORRECTIVE ACTION PLAN

Recommended Solution Segment

This section outlines the integrated technology solution proposed to resolve operational bottlenecks, replacing the legacy recommendations register.

Implementation Required

Solution Modules to be Built:

1 Logistics & Supply Chain Dashboard

- **Structured Order Intake Form:** A dedicated shareable intake form (accessible via link) replaces WhatsApp ordering entirely. Sales teams or clients fill it out directly; it auto-populates a central shared data layer accessible to Logistics, Accounts, Production, and R&D. Reorder data from repeat clients is auto-fetched — eliminating the need to re-confirm shipping details every time.
- **Centralised Shipment Dashboard:** A single source of truth for all domestic and international shipments — replacing scattered Sheets and WhatsApp updates. CXOs can check any shipment's status independently without asking Nihal.
- **Role-Based Access Control (RBAC):** Designed for future team expansion. Documents like gate passes and challans can be securely shared with Accounts, Sales, or Clients directly from the dashboard using access controls.

2 Zoho Books Integration & Document Automation

- **Zoho Books API Sync:** A direct API connection from Zoho Books into the Logistics Dashboard auto-populates all dispatch tracking fields, eliminating manual double-entry across billing and shipping systems.
- **Automated Document Flow:** E-gate passes, delivery challans, and all shipping documents are auto-generated and uploaded directly to the designated Google Drive folders — fully eliminating the current manual Zoho → PDF → Drive → email loop.

3 Carrier Tracking & Vessel Visibility

- **API Integration (where available):** If carrier or shipping line APIs exist for current logistics partners, they will be integrated to provide automated vessel schedule alerts and real-time tracking updates directly in the dashboard.
- **Dashboard Tracking Form (fallback):** Where APIs are not available, a structured dashboard form connected to the Google Sheets tracking system manages all tracking IDs and links, providing real-time visibility to all departments — eliminating the current WhatsApp-based status chase.

4 WhatsApp Monitoring & Alert Bot

- **Vendor & Client Group Intelligence:** A WhatsApp bot integrated into vendor and client groups monitors incoming messages for tracking notifications, vendor payment updates, and invoicing confirmations.
- **Dashboard Alerts:** The bot flags pending or upcoming invoices, outstanding vendor payments, and delivery red flags directly on the Logistics Head's dashboard — converting unstructured WhatsApp signals into structured, actionable alerts.

What Remains the Same

- **Existing Workflows Preserved:** Google Sheets, WhatsApp, Email, and Slack remain. Integration improves them — it does not replace them.
- **Vendor Experience Unchanged:** External partners and vendors will not need to adopt any new platform.

Tech Stack Utilized

- **Frontend:** ReactJS + TypeScript
- **APIs:** Google Sheets, Drive, WhatsApp, Slack, Gmail, Zoho Books
- **Carrier APIs:** Integrated where available from logistics partners

Key Operational Problems Solved

- Eliminates the 10–25 minute per-order data chasing loop from WhatsApp order intake.
- Ends manual double-entry between Zoho Books and Google Sheets for every shipment.
- Provides CXOs instant shipment visibility without routing through the Logistics Head.
- Consolidates all packaging, tracking, and document records into a single searchable, trackable database.

Future Scope of Improvement / Enhancement

- **Predictive Cost & Time Model:** Based on historical order data, instantly estimate delivery time and transportation cost for new orders so Sales can give accurate commitments to customers without waiting for Logistics to manually calculate.
- **Automated Vendor Rate Optimization:** Automate rate comparison from the maintained vendor rate sheet when a new order arrives, surfacing the optimal carrier automatically.

Next Steps for Team Adoption

- **Sales Team Mandate:** Sales leadership must mandate exclusive use of the dashboard intake form. Any order submitted via WhatsApp without using the form is to be returned for resubmission.
- **Feedback Loop:** Establish a continuous feedback loop to iterate on the solution on the ground, ensuring it genuinely adapts to the team's operational reality and achieves sustained adoption.



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SECTION 07 — IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

Phased Roadmap

Initiatives sequenced across three phases, with quantified ROI and scope of work

INITIATIVE		PHASE 1 WEEKS 1–4	PHASE 2 WEEKS 5–9	PHASE 3 WEEKS 10–12
Logistics Dashboard & Intake Form	Module 1	●		
Zoho Books Sync & Document Automation	Module 2		●	
Carrier Tracking & Vessel Visibility	Module 3		●	
WhatsApp Monitoring & Alert Bot	Module 4			●

Phase 1 — Core Dashboard & Intake Discipline

Weeks 1–4 · Replacing WhatsApp Ordering

Maturity 1.6 → 2.2

SCOPE OF WORK & DEPENDENCIES

- **Build:** Logistics & Supply Chain Dashboard with structured order intake form (shareable via link). Auto-populates shared data layer for Logistics, Accounts, Production, and R&D.
- **Build:** Repeat client auto-fetch — shipping details pre-populated from history; no re-confirmation needed from Sales.
- **Tech Stack & Badges:** [React.js Dashboard](#) [Google Sheets API](#) .
- **Team Adoption:** Conduct mandatory walkthrough sessions for Logistics and Sales teams on the new intake form and dashboard UI.
- **Client To-Do:** Sales leadership to issue a formal policy mandating use of the dashboard form. Provide Google Workspace API access and map the approval hierarchy.

↓ 30%

ADMIN TIME

Manager reclaims hours previously spent chasing missing BD data per order.

Zero

INTAKE ERRORS

Form validation eliminates missing pin codes, GST numbers, and SKU errors.

Instant

REPEAT ORDERS

Historical address auto-fetch prevents redundant client re-confirmation.

Phase 2 — Systems Integration & Tracking

Weeks 5–9 · Data Unification & Vessel Visibility

Maturity 2.2 → 2.7

SCOPE OF WORK & DEPENDENCIES

- **Build:** Zoho Books API sync to auto-populate dispatch tracking fields and eliminate manual double-entry.
- **Build:** Automated generation and upload of e-gate passes, challans, and shipping documents to Google Drive — fully eliminating the manual Zoho → PDF → Drive → email loop.
- **Build:** Carrier tracking integration (API where available, dashboard form fallback). Real-time visibility across all departments without WhatsApp status chases.
- **Tech Stack & Badges:** [Zoho Books API](#) [Google Drive API](#) [Carrier APIs](#) .
- **Client To-Do:** Accounts to grant Logistics read/write API access to Zoho Books. Provide existing carrier contact lists for API availability check.

100%

SINGLE ENTRY

Automated

DOCUMENTS

Live

VESSEL TRACKING

Direct Zoho Books sync entirely eliminates manual double-typing per shipment.	E-gate passes and challans auto-generated and uploaded without manual intervention.	All departments see real-time shipment status without pinging the Logistics Head.
Phase 3 — WhatsApp Intelligence & Unified OS Weeks 10–12 · Scaling Visibility & Automation Maturity 2.7 → 3.0		
SCOPE OF WORK & DEPENDENCIES • Build: WhatsApp bot integrated into vendor and client groups — monitors tracking notifications, vendor payment updates, and invoicing confirmations automatically. • Build: Dashboard alert layer — bot flags pending invoices, upcoming vendor payments, and delivery red flags directly on the Logistics Head's dashboard. • Build: Connect the Logistics Dashboard into the broader EF Polymer unified OS for CXO-level role-based access. • Tech Stack & Badges: WhatsApp Business API Slack API GCP . • Client To-Do: Provide WhatsApp Business API access. Share vendor and client group contact lists for bot onboarding. Confirm CXO access hierarchy for the unified OS.		
Automated INVOICE ALERTS Bot flags pending invoices and vendor payments — zero manual monitoring needed.	1-Click CXO VISIBILITY Instant board-level shipment status via the Unified OS. No more calling Nihal.	Sustained USAGE Feedback loop ensures the solution adapts to the team's operational reality.



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System Impact: Before & After

Measurable improvements post-implementation

CATEGORY	BEFORE (CURRENT STATE)	AFTER (POST-IMPLEMENTATION)
Order Intake	Unstructured WhatsApp messages with missing fields. 10–25 mins of chasing per order.	Structured Dashboard Form. All mandatory fields enforced at submission. Zero chasing required.
Data Tracking & Storage	Scattered across Zoho Books, Google Sheets, Google Drive, and WhatsApp groups. Manual double-entry for every shipment.	1 Centralised Dashboard. Real-time bi-directional sync with Zoho Books and Sheets. Single Source of Truth.
Document Generation	Manual: Zoho Books → PDF → Google Drive → email for every shipment.	Fully Automated. E-gate passes, challans, and shipping docs auto-generated and uploaded to Drive without manual steps.
Carrier & Vessel Visibility	Manual tracking via WhatsApp updates. No alerts for vessel prepone/postpone events.	Live Dashboard Tracking. API-integrated or dashboard-managed tracking IDs visible to all departments in real-time.
CXO & Cross-Dept Visibility	All status queries routed through Nihal directly. No self-serve mechanism.	Role-Based Dashboard Access. CXOs and other departments check shipment status independently with no interruptions.
Invoice & Vendor Alerts	No alerting system. Pending invoices and vendor payments tracked manually via WhatsApp and memory.	WhatsApp Bot Alerts. Bot monitors vendor/client groups and flags pending invoices, payments, and delivery issues directly on the Logistics Head's dashboard.
Department Maturity Score	1.6 / 5.0 (Ad-hoc)	3.0 / 5.0 (Systematised)

Quantified Executive Time Savings

Estimated annual bandwidth reclaimed for the Logistics Head (Nihal Paliwal & team) by eliminating order intake data chasing and manual document uploads.

10–25 min CHASING TIME / ORDER	100% SINGLE-ENTRY SYNC	20 hrs MONTHLY TIME SAVED	240 hrs ANNUAL HOURS SAVED
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Bandwidth Reinvestment Breakdown:

- Current Friction:** Logistics Lead spends 10–25 minutes per order manually clarifying incomplete WhatsApp intake fields and performing double-entry between Zoho Books and Drive.
- Automated Efficiency:** Structured Mobile Intake Form auto-validates inputs while direct Zoho Books and Drive APIs auto-generate e-gate passes and shipping documents.

- **Strategic Impact:** Reclaims **240 Logistics hours per year (~30 full working days)** to focus on freight carrier rate optimization, regional warehouse planning, and export container routing.